IFAB®

THE INTERNATIONAL FOOTBALL ASSOCIATION BOARD



Law 14

The Penalty Kick

A penalty kick is awarded if a player commits a direct free kick offence inside their penalty area or off the field as part of play as outlined in Laws 12 and 13.

A goal may be scored directly from a penalty kick.

1. Procedure

The ball must be stationary, with part of the ball touching or overhanging the centre of the penalty mark, and the goalposts, crossbar and goal net must not be moving.

The player taking the penalty kick must be clearly identified.

The defending goalkeeper must remain on the goal line, facing the kicker, between the goalposts, until the ball is kicked. The goalkeeper must not behave in a way that unfairly distracts the kicker, e.g. delay the taking of the kick or touch the goalposts, crossbar or goal net.

The players other than the kicker and goalkeeper must be:

- at least 9.15 m (10 yds) from the penalty mark
- behind the penalty mark
- inside the field of play
- outside the penalty area

After the players have taken positions in accordance with this Law, the referee signals for the penalty kick to be taken.

The player taking the penalty kick must kick the ball forward; backheeling is permitted provided the ball moves forward.

When the ball is kicked, the defending goalkeeper must have at least part of one foot touching, in line with, or behind, the goal line.

The ball is in play when it is kicked and clearly moves.

The kicker must not play the ball again until it has touched another player.

The penalty kick is completed when the ball stops moving, goes out of play or the referee stops play for any offence.

Additional time is allowed for a penalty kick to be taken and completed at the end of each half of the match or extra time. When additional time is allowed, the penalty kick is completed when, after the kick has been taken, the ball stops moving, goes out of play, is played by any player (including the kicker) other than the defending goalkeeper, or the referee stops play for an offence by the kicker or the kicker's team. If a defending team player (including the goalkeeper) commits an offence and the penalty is missed/saved, the penalty is retaken.

2. Offences and sanctions

Once the referee has signalled for a penalty kick to be taken, the kick must be taken; if it is not taken, the referee may take disciplinary action before signalling again for the kick to be taken.

If, before the ball is in play, one of the following occurs:

- the kicker accidentally kicks the ball with both feet simultaneously or the ball touches their non-kicking foot or leg immediately after the kick:
  - if the ball enters the goal from the kick, the kick is retaken
  - if the ball does not enter the goal from the kick, an indirect free kick is awarded
- a team-mate of the player taking the penalty kick is penalised for encroachment only if:
  - the encroachment clearly impacted on the goalkeeper; or
  - the encroaching player plays the ball or challenges an opponent for the ball and then scores, attempts to score or creates a goal-scoring opportunity

- a team-mate of the goalkeeper is penalised for encroachment only if:
  - the encroachment clearly impacted on the kicker; or
  - the encroaching player plays the ball or challenges an opponent for the ball and this prevents the opponents from scoring, attempting to score or creating a goal-scoring opportunity
- the player taking the penalty kick or a team-mate offends:
  - if the ball enters the goal from the kick, the kick is retaken
  - if the ball does not enter the goal from the kick, the referee stops play and restarts with an indirect free kick

  except for the following when play will be stopped and restarted with an indirect free kick, regardless of whether or not a goal is scored:

  - a penalty kick is kicked backwards
  - a team-mate of the identified kicker takes the kick; the referee cautions the player who took the kick
  - feinting to kick the ball once the kicker has completed the run-up (feinting in the run-up is permitted); the referee cautions the kicker
- the goalkeeper offends:
  - if the ball enters the goal from the kick, a goal is awarded
  - if the ball misses the goal or rebounds from the crossbar or goalpost(s), the kick is only retaken if the goalkeeper's offence clearly impacted on the kicker
  - if the ball is prevented from entering the goal by the goalkeeper, the kick is retaken

  If the goalkeeper's offence results in the kick being retaken, the goalkeeper is warned for the first offence in the game and cautioned for any subsequent offence(s) in the game
- a team-mate of the goalkeeper offends:
  - if the ball enters the goal from the kick, a goal is awarded
  - if the ball does not enter the goal from the kick, the kick is retaken

- a player of both teams offends, the kick is retaken unless a player commits a more serious offence (e.g. 'illegal' feinting)

If, after the penalty kick has been taken:

- the kicker deliberately touches the ball again before it has touched another player:
  - an indirect free kick (or direct free kick for a handball offence) is awarded
- the ball is touched by an outside agent as it moves forward:
  - the kick is retaken unless the ball is going into the goal and the interference does not prevent the goalkeeper or a defending player playing the ball, in which case the goal is awarded if the ball enters the goal (even if contact was made with the ball) unless the interference was by the attacking team
- the ball rebounds into the field of play from the goalkeeper, the crossbar or the goalposts and is then touched by an outside agent:
  - the referee stops play
  - play is restarted with a dropped ball at the position where it touched the outside agent

3. Summary table

	Outcome of the penalty kick	
	Goal scored from the kick	**No goal scored from the kick**
Encroachment only by attacking player(s)	Impact: penalty is retaken No impact: goal	Impact: indirect free kick No impact: no retake
Encroachment only by defending player(s)	Impact: goal No impact: goal	Impact: penalty is retaken No impact: no retake

Encroachment by defending and attacking player(s)	Impact by both defending and attacking player(s): penalty is retaken Impact by defending player(s) only: goal Impact by attacking player(s) only: penalty is retaken No impact: goal	Impact by both defending and attacking player(s): penalty is retaken Impact by defending player(s) only: penalty is retaken Impact by attacking player(s) only: no retake No impact: no retake
Offence only by goalkeeper	Goal	Not saved: penalty is not retaken (unless kicker is clearly impacted) Saved: penalty is retaken and warning for goalkeeper; caution for any further offence(s)
Goalkeeper and kicker offend at the same time	Penalty is retaken unless kicker commits one of the offences below	Penalty is retaken unless kicker commits one of the offences below
Double touch by kicker	Accidental: penalty is retaken Deliberate: indirect free kick	Accidental: indirect free kick; penalty is retaken if goalkeeper also offends Deliberate: indirect free kick
Ball kicked backwards	Indirect free kick	Indirect free kick
'Illegal' feinting	Indirect free kick and caution for kicker	Indirect free kick and caution for kicker
Wrong kicker	Indirect free kick and caution for wrong kicker	Indirect free kick and caution for wrong kicker
Unsporting behaviour by kicker	Indirect free kick and caution for kicker	Indirect free kick and caution for kicker